

A "safe sandbox Friday" template

Give every banker on your team 60 minutes of permission to try something.

Adoption does not happen in mandatory training. It happens when a teller, a back-office analyst, or a branch manager finds one thing that saves them 20 minutes on a Tuesday — and tells the person next to them.

You do not need a vendor or a budget to start that. You need permission and a structure.

Three things you can do this week

1. **Pick one Friday.** Block 60 minutes on every banker's calendar. Title: "Safe Sandbox — try one AI tool on a real task."
2. **Pick the boundaries.** No customer PII, no financial data, no proprietary documents. Public information and synthetic examples only. Write this on the invite.
3. **Make sharing the cost of admission.** Ask each participant to submit one short note: what they tried, what worked, what did not. Compile and circulate. The list itself becomes your seed library.

A starter prompt for your invite

This Friday is our first Safe Sandbox hour. Pick one task you do regularly — drafting an email, summarizing a document, writing a follow-up — and try it with [tool name]. Use only public information or made-up examples. No customer data, no internal numbers. Bring back one thing that worked and one thing that did not. We learn together or not at all.

Why this is the right first step

A learning culture is built from observed behavior, not stated values. The institutions that move fastest from early-stage AI to coordinated programs are the ones whose staff have already experimented enough to know what is real. Sixty minutes a month is the cheapest investment in that you can make.

Citations

- AI Playbook for Banks and Credit Unions, Cornerstone Advisors, 2025
- Getting Started in AI, Jack Henry & Associates, 2025

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